

ETHICAWKS FORENSIC GOVERNANCE & COMPLIANCE CONSULTANCY

Technical Data Governance Clause

POPIA Compliance and Data Anonymization Framework | 26 June 2026

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1. Data Minimization and Anonymization Protocol

The EthicHawks API is engineered to function under a "Privacy-First" architecture. Data ingested by the system is strictly limited to the operational and systemic parameters required for forensic analysis. No direct personal identifiers — including but not limited to patient names, identity numbers, or contact details — are stored in the system's persistent storage.

2. Tokenization and Irreversibility

Upon ingestion at the API gateway, all sensitive data points are processed through an irreversible tokenization protocol. Each unique identifier — for example, a specific Patient File ID or Staff Employee ID — is mapped to a randomized, non-reversible token string.

- **Destruction of Linkability:** The mapping key used for tokenization is maintained exclusively by the data provider (the client) and is never transmitted to, stored by, or accessible to the EthicHawks API.
- **Irreversibility:** Once data is tokenized, it is mathematically impossible for EthicHawks to reverse-engineer or re-identify the original data subject. Consequently, the data processed by the EthicHawks engine ceases to qualify as "Personal Information" as defined under Section 1 of POPIA.

3. Cryptographic Integrity — The Immutable Audit Trail

To ensure the integrity of the forensic evidence, all processed telemetry data is verified using SHA-256 cryptographic hashing. This process creates a unique digital signature for the dataset, ensuring that the evidence bundle generated is tamper-evident and historically accurate, without requiring the retention of any personally identifiable information.

This cryptographic verification ensures that compliance reports produced by the EthicHawks engine are audit-ready without compromising the data privacy of any individuals referenced in the original source logs.

4. Data Governance

EthicHawks operates as a "Data Processor" as defined by POPIA, acting only on the instructions of the "Data Controller" — the Hospital or Client institution. We do not aggregate data across different client environments. Every facility's telemetry data is siloed in a discrete, encrypted environment, ensuring no cross-contamination of sensitive information.

Operational Clarification: Incident Mapping Protocol

The following narrative addresses a question commonly raised by legal and compliance teams regarding the operationalization of the tokenization framework.

Q: "How do we map the token back to the person if we need to investigate a specific incident?"

A: "The mapping key stays in your internal, secure database. When the EthicHawks system flags a 'Red Flag' on Token ID X92-J7, your authorized internal privacy officer simply references your internal mapping table to identify the underlying record. I have no access to that table, which is exactly how we ensure 100% POPIA compliance."